E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 2: Pronouns, word meaning and finding details – Handouts

Handout 2A: Follow the arrows

Draw an arrow from each **bold** word to the person or thing it means. Then write the answer.

1. Maria has two brothers. **They** live in Leeds. They = _____

2. The council sent Ahmed a letter. **He** put **it** in his bag and forgot about it. He = _____ it = _____

3. Nasra met her neighbours at the market. **She** invited **them** for tea. She = _____ them = _____

4. The bus was late and the passengers were cold. When **it** finally arrived, **they** cheered. it = _____ they = _____

5. Mr Chen gave the students a form. **He** asked **them** to return **it** by Friday. He = _____ them = _____ it = _____

Handout 2B: Two Wheels and a New Start

1 When Farid Rahimi arrived in London two years ago, he knew nobody. He lived in a hostel in Dalston and spent most of his money on bus fares. His English class was four miles away, so he travelled for nearly an hour each way.

2 One day his teacher, Mrs Okafor, told him about a bicycle workshop near the canal. **It** gives old bikes to people who need them. She wrote the address on a piece of paper and gave it to him. He went there the next Saturday.

3 The workshop was noisy and crowded. A mechanic called Rosa showed Farid a rusty blue bicycle. “It is yours,” she said, “but first you must repair it.” Farid had never fixed anything before. Rosa was patient. She taught him how to change a tyre and mend the brakes. After three Saturdays, **it** was ready.

4 The bicycle changed Farid’s life. He now gets to college in twenty minutes and he saves about fifteen pounds a week. He also feels healthier. At first, the busy roads frightened him, so he took a free cycling lesson from the council. Now he rides with confidence.

5 Farid still goes to the workshop every Saturday, but these days he is a volunteer. He helps new visitors choose a bike and shows **them** how to look after it. “Rosa gave me more than a bicycle,” he says. “She gave me a skill. I want to pass **it** on.”

Handout 2C: Questions on Two Wheels and a New Start

Name: _____ Date: _____

Section A: Pronouns. Circle A, B, C or D.

1. In paragraph 2, ‘It’ means:

A. the canal B. the workshop C. the English class D. the hostel

2. In paragraph 3, what is ‘it’ in ‘After three Saturdays, it was ready’?

A. the tyre B. the piece of paper C. the bicycle D. the workshop

3. In paragraph 5, ‘them’ means:

A. the bikes B. Rosa and Farid C. the Saturdays D. new visitors

4. In paragraph 5, ‘pass it on’ means pass on:

A. the skill B. the bicycle C. the workshop D. the address

Section B: Word meaning. Find the word in the text. Read the words before and after it – they help you. Then circle A, B, C or D.

Example (paragraph 3): “The workshop was **noisy** and *crowded*.”
The word **noisy** helps you. A noisy place has a lot of people in it. So *crowded* = full of people.
Do the same for questions 5 to 8.

5. Paragraph 3: ‘Rosa was patient.’ ‘Patient’ means:

A. in a hurry B. calm and happy to wait

C. unwell D. very strict

6. Paragraph 3: ‘mend the brakes’. ‘Mend’ means:

A. buy B. clean

C. make something work again D. test

7. Paragraph 4: ‘the busy roads frightened him’. ‘Frightened him’ means:

A. made him bored B. made him late C. made him angry D. made him afraid

8. Paragraph 4: ‘Now he rides with confidence.’ ‘With confidence’ means:

A. very slowly B. without fear C. every day D. with other people

Section C: Details. Circle A, B, C or D. Write the paragraph number next to your answer.

9. Before he had the bike, how long was Farid’s journey to class? Para: ___

A. About 20 minutes B. Almost sixty minutes C. Two hours D. Four hours

10. Who first told Farid about the workshop? Para: ___

A. A mechanic B. Someone at the hostel

C. The person who taught his class D. Someone from the council

11. What did Farid have to do before the bike was his? Para: ___

A. Pay fifteen pounds B. Do the repairs himself

C. Pass a cycling test D. Work for free for three weeks

12. Why did Farid take a lesson from the council? Para: ___

A. He was nervous in traffic B. He wanted to become a mechanic

C. His bike kept breaking D. The college asked him to

13. What does Farid do at the workshop now? Para: ___

A. He sells bikes B. He learns to change tyres

C. He helps people who are new there D. He teaches English